

No real plan

Nokia admits that it doesn't really have a plan for tablet devices in place

Voice control added

LG adds voice control to the Magic Remotes for the Smart TV range



Sony Tablet S

the device. However, the potential is immense. Expect Sony to port most of its PSP titles to the tablet soon, making the Tablet S the first real gaming tablet in the market. The universal remote is a huge value addition, thanks to the integrated RF sensor. Battery life is quite handy as well, it will last about six hours of continuous video viewing. For

there. Its 10.1-inch display doesn't have the colour vividness of an iPad or a Galaxy Tab, but the display looks crisp and clean. Brightness levels aren't the brightest around, but sufficient enough for most usage scenarios. Lenovo hasn't said anything about when the K1 will be updated from Android 3.1 to Android 3.2. The UI treatment done over Android is quite profound. Multiple shortcuts and a dock have been added, just to reduce the number of clicks to get to the oft-used apps: browser, media, etc. Lenovo has preloaded about 30 games and apps on the K1, and that just helps with the use-straight-out-of-the-box scenario. However, we did notice some chinks in the K1's armor. It has the habit of sometimes not responding while waking up from sleep. Multiple stabs at the button elicit a response. Secondly, 20 minutes of web browsing will be enough to really warm up a part of the rear panel. And the build quality is a huge disappointment. The plastic doesn't look or feel very high quality, and suffers from flex issues towards the middle of the rear panel. For someone spending close to ₹30k for a tablet, this kind of build quality may just be a huge deal breaker.

Moving on to a tablet that feels well built, the Asus Transformer. The Waveface UI is an extremely neat one, and

we must commend the excellent 10.1-inch IPS LED display for making it look so good! Speaking of which, the sharpness was more than welcome when watching videos and really helps when reading text. At 680 grams, the Transformer isn't the lightest tablet around, but when coupled with 13mm thickness, it's very comfortable to hold for long durations. We've been noticing on various shopping web sites that the keyboard dock is being bundled free with the Transformer. In that case, this makes an excellent package.

Once docked, it looks like a netbook to someone who may not have seen the tablet individually. The keys on the dock are very comfortable to use, and feels just like a proper laptop keyboard, complete with the touchpad and palm rest areas. The built-in battery on this dock enhances the backup time on offer. The Transformer seems to have everything going for it – good performance, classy build and looks and a dock that makes it an excellent netbook alternative.

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ASUS EeePad Transformer

The only enhancement the Acer Iconia A501 gets over the Iconia A500 is the 3G SIM card slot. And a slightly higher price tag! We have absolutely no hesitation in recommending this for a consideration, particularly after the Android 3.2 update. It does have a lot going for it, namely performance and



Acer Iconia A501

a decent battery life. The 3G version appeals to someone who wants connectivity on the move.

Now we talk about possibly the most aggressive of the iPad rivals to have arrived in the market this year – the Samsung Galaxy Tab 750. At 8.6mm, it managed to be slimmer than the iPad 2 (8.8mm)! And the plastic body helped it to be lighter as well. When it arrived in the market, it was by far the quickest Android tablet to rival the Apple

masterpiece. However, the sheen seems to have come off since then. The Asus Eee Pad Transformer, the Acer Iconia A501 and even the Sony Tablet S, to a certain extent, have matched that performance.

This one is no longer the real iPad 2 rival. But that shouldn't take any credit away from an excellent package. The build quality is really good, even though the use of plastic throughout takes away



Lenovo IdeaPad K1

the light "coffee table" usage pattern, this should last a handful of days on a single charge.

Considerably surprising is the solid performance of the Lenovo IdeaPad K1. The benchmarks indicated reasonably quick performance, and even in real life that was the case. Among all the tablets in this shootout, the K1 had the quickest boot time – about 18 seconds. Damn impressive, and the K1 just builds on from